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Experiment – 12 : Security and Governance in Zoho Creator

Aim

To study and apply security and governance concepts in Zoho Creator for the Event Desk event management platform, focusing on user access control, data protection, permissions, authentication, workflow security, and responsible application management.

Theory

Security and governance are essential for protecting application data, controlling user access, and ensuring that an application follows defined management policies. Zoho Creator provides features for managing users, configuring permissions, controlling access to application components, and maintaining secure application operations.

In the Event Desk platform, participant details, registration statuses, email addresses, workflows, and API integrations must be managed securely.

The following concepts are relevant to the platform:

1. User Authentication

Authentication verifies the identity of users before they access the application. Proper authentication helps prevent unauthorized access to participant registration information.

2. Role-Based Access Control

Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) assigns permissions according to user roles. Administrators may require broader access, while participants should only access the functions and information permitted to them.

3. Form and Report Permissions

The Event_Registration_Form and Event_Registration_Report contain participant information. Their permissions should be configured to control who can view, add, modify, or delete records.

4. Dashboard Access Control

The Registration Status Board, Participation Dashboard, and AI Registration Analytics Dashboard display registration-related information. Access should be limited according to the responsibilities of each user.

5. Data Privacy and Protection

Participant email addresses and other registration details should be handled carefully. Access should be restricted to authorized users, and unnecessary exposure of personal information should be avoided.

6. Workflow Security

The application uses workflows for registration confirmation, pending-payment reminders, status synchronization, duplicate prevention, update notifications, and target monitoring. Workflow conditions and permissions should be reviewed to prevent unintended actions or unauthorized data changes.

7. API and Credential Security

The event_registration_api_connection connection and associated API functions require appropriate authentication and authorization. API keys, OAuth client secrets, and other credentials should not be exposed in public pages, screenshots, or source code repositories.

8. Governance and Application Management

Governance involves maintaining clear rules for application ownership, access permissions, configuration changes, data handling, and ongoing maintenance. Regular reviews help keep the application organized and secure.

9. Audit and Monitoring

Application activity, workflow behavior, and configuration changes should be reviewed using the monitoring and audit features available in the selected Zoho Creator environment. This helps identify unexpected behavior and supports accountability.

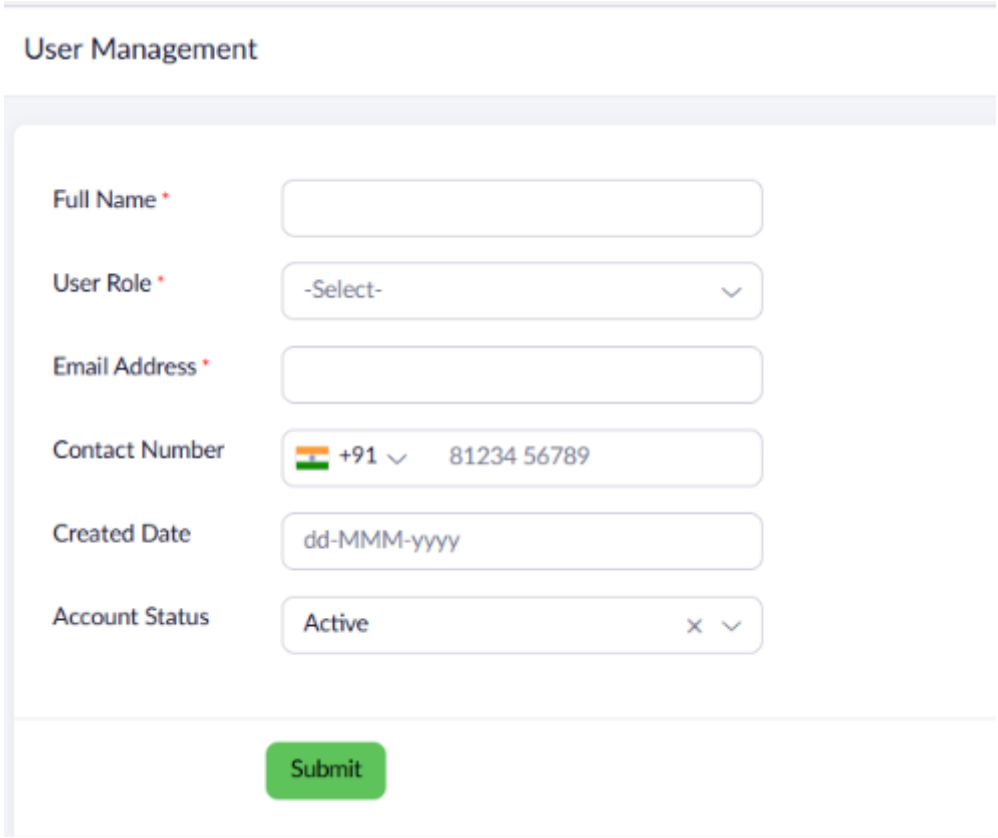
Together, these security and governance practices help protect participant information and support reliable management of the Event Desk application.

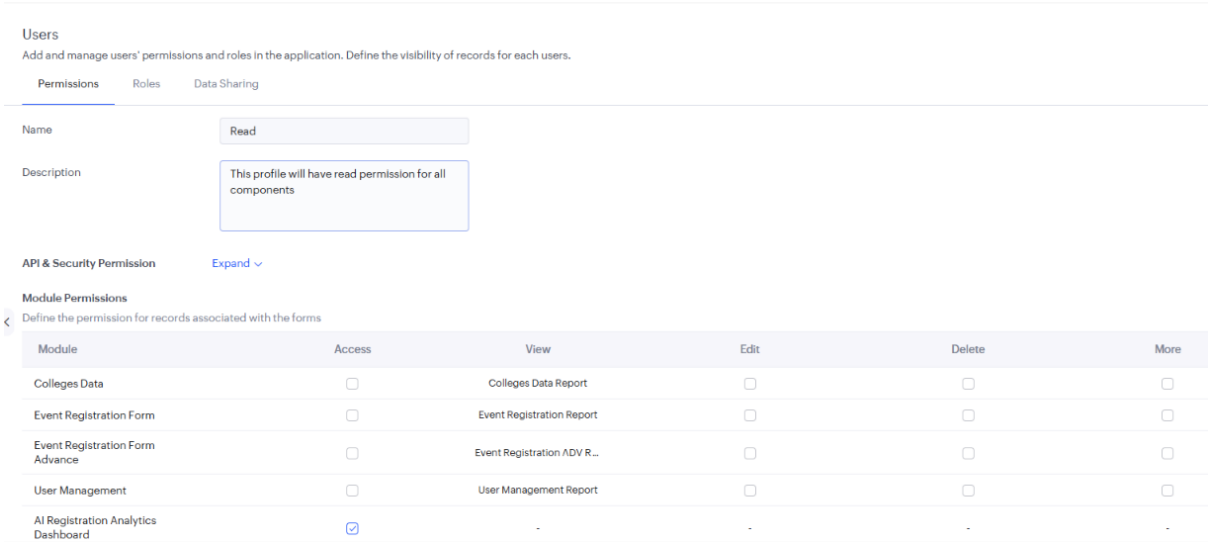
Procedure

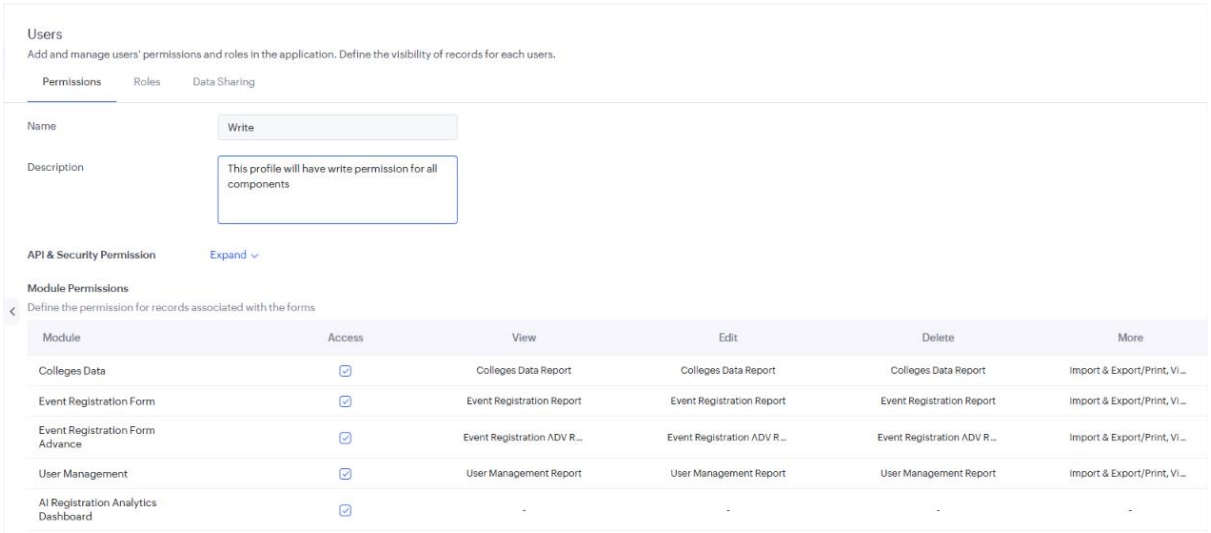
1. Open the Event Desk application in Zoho Creator.
2. Review the available user management and application access settings.
3. Identify the different user categories, such as administrators, organizers, and participants.
4. Review the available role and permission configuration options.

5. Examine the access permissions for Event_Registration_Form.
6. Review the viewing and editing permissions for Event_Registration_Report.
7. Check access restrictions for the Registration Status Board and other dashboards.
8. Review the six existing workflows and identify the conditions under which they execute.
9. Examine the API connection and associated functions to identify authentication and authorization requirements.
10. Ensure that sensitive credentials are stored securely and are not exposed to unauthorized users.
11. Review the handling of participant email addresses and registration information.
12. Examine available monitoring or audit features for reviewing application activity.
13. Test the configured permissions using appropriate test accounts, where available.
14. Verify that authorized users can perform their permitted actions and restricted users cannot access prohibited functions.
15. Review the configuration and document any security improvements that may be required.

Screenshots







Result

Security and governance concepts were studied in the context of the Event Desk platform. The experiment covers authentication, role-based permissions, participant data protection, workflow review, API security, and application monitoring. These practices provide a structured approach to securing the application. The actual level of protection depends on the permissions, authentication settings, and security controls configured and verified in Zoho Creator.